



SUPER CHEAP

supercheap.market · working name

The affordable, stylish, factory-direct shopping app for young women who shop from the feed.

Factory-direct fashion

TikTok + Pinterest native

Factory-direct, quality-checked

Pre-seed Aleksei Balchunas - solo founder 2026

PROBLEM

Huge purchase intent, nowhere good to spend it

A young woman sees an outfit on TikTok or Pinterest and wants it now, affordably. The path from that spark to a purchase she can trust is broken.

**Discovery lives in the feed**

She finds the look on TikTok or Pinterest, not by searching a store.

**Buying is a scavenger hunt**

Hunting across apps, decoding machine-translated Chinese listings.

**Every order is a gamble**

Will it fit? Is the quality real? Will it even arrive? All unknown.

**It feels like importing, not shopping**

The magic of the trend dies in a 3-6 week customs-grade experience.

Four bad options, and she bounces between them



Temu / AliExpress

Cheapest, but they optimize for scale: reseller listings, weak QC, a prepaid gamble on size.

Wins on price. Loses on trust.



Shein

Consistent quality, but priced above direct sourcing and limited to its own catalog.

Wins on speed. Can't sell the exact pin.



Social resellers (WhatsApp / IG)

Closest to the stylish, curated feel, but manual, prepay-a-stranger, no returns.

Wins on taste. Loses on safety.



Local retail

No sizing gamble, but the same China-made goods at a steep markup, no trend selection.

Wins on instant. Loses on price.

None solves sizing and quality certainty before the item ships, for this audience.

THE INSIGHT

Same factories, different buying model

China has hundreds of millions of SKUs. We buy directly from factories and suppliers, then use audience + recommender to choose the right slice.



Same supply, different slice

Temu optimizes for “cheapest” through broad reseller listings. We buy direct from factories, then surface a curated, stylish slice.



The audience trains the catalog

Our traffic was young women from TikTok, so our engine learned to surface stylish, Pinterest-like items. It became a curated showroom, not a discount warehouse.



Different app, different job

People keep several feeds open for different moods. Commerce splits the same way: a “cheap random stuff” app and a separate “affordable but stylish” one.

We don't beat Temu on breadth. We remove the reseller layer, curate a different slice of the same supply, and add trust before shipping.

SOLUTION

A factory-direct feed with a trust layer no one else ships



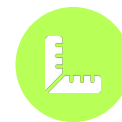
Curated stylish feed

TikTok/Pinterest looks matched to real in-stock items, personalized for young women.



Pre-ship studio photo

Before we ship, she sees the actual item shot on a measurement grid under good lighting.



See true size & quality

The grid shows real measurements and finish, so “will it fit?” gets an answer up front.



Refuse at our warehouse

If it's not right, she declines it at our hub and doesn't lose her money.



Enhanced QC in China

We inspect harder than generic platforms, because this audience won't tolerate junk.

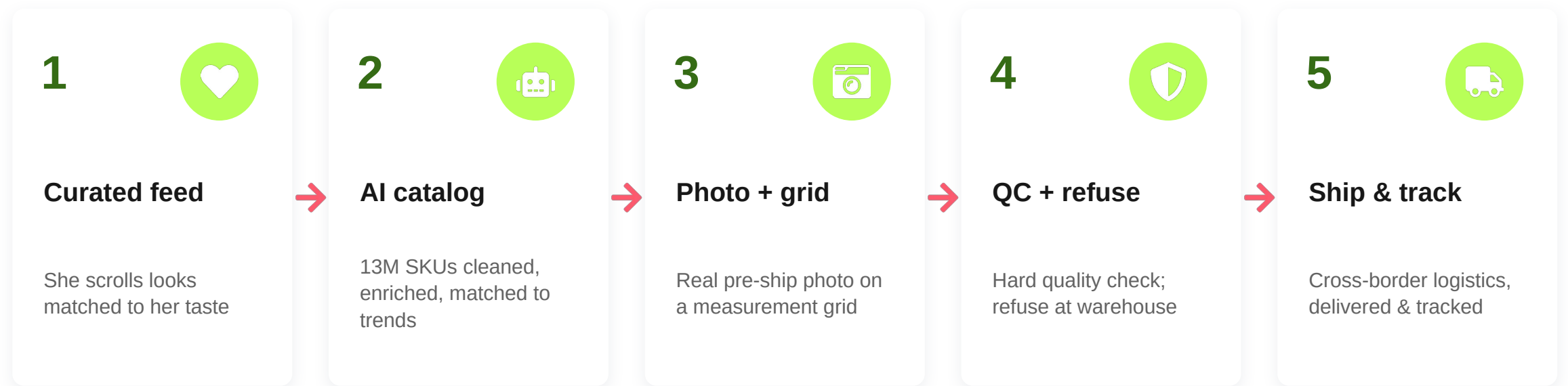


Direct factory supply

Buy directly from real manufacturers. No reseller layer means lower prices and clearer accountability.

The wedge: sizing fear and quality doubt stop conversion and reorder. Direct supply keeps price low; we answer both before the box ships.

How it works, end to end



The value isn't access to Chinese supply. Everyone has that. It's direct factory buying plus trust and personalization on top.

WHY NOW

A small team can now build a trust-first marketplace

BEFORE

Catalog, translation, recommendations, moderation, support, logistics and creative all needed a large, expensive team.



TODAY

AI automates most of the stack. One operator who's done it before can build a more personal, higher-quality marketplace, faster and leaner.



The tariff reset leveled the field. The end of US de minimis (May 2025) forced Shein and Temu to raise prices, so incumbents lost part of their price moat right as the AI window opened. Whoever builds the vertical, trust-first marketplace first takes the category.

PROOF, PREVIOUS VERSION

✓ Validated, not projected

The model was already validated with real money

\$489K GMV	14.3K Orders	7.6K Buyers	\$1.3M Annualized run-rate
~\$8 Paid CAC / buyer	~\$0.09 TikTok CPI	\$34 Gross AOV (\$27 net)	11-13.5% Repeat, first 3 mo

Achieved in our initial launch market with no trust layer at all. CAC was ≈ 23% of a single first order, with room to scale spend as repeat compounds. This is the operator's track record, the new entity starts at zero.

MARKET

A large market where we don't fight incumbents head-on

TAM

\$1.0T+

Global fashion e-commerce (~\$1.06T in 2025), the category Temu, Shein and Zara compete in.

SAM

\$150-200B

Affordable, trend-driven fashion for young online shoppers, discovered through TikTok, Instagram and Pinterest.

SOM

\$10-20B

Mobile-first social commerce in our target markets with cross-border supply. Target: 1-2% of the segment in 3-5 years.

Where we start

 US

One of the world's largest fashion e-commerce markets (~20% of global).

 Brazil

Among the fastest-growing, TikTok-native, cross-border demand rising.

 Mexico

Same profile as Brazil; Stripe/dLocal rails already in place.

Margin now, platform revenue later

CORE TODAY

Margin on every order

Buy directly from vetted manufacturers, with no reseller layer. Sell at a curated markup still below Shein. Gross AOV \$34 / net \$27 in the previous version.

Positive ROI at 6-12 months on paid social

EXPANSION REVENUE (planned)



Seller onboarding → commission

Open the vetted pool to more suppliers on take-rate.



Ads & promoted placements

Sponsored slots once demand density is there.



B2B wholesale

Bulk supply for small businesses and resellers.



Adjacent categories

Beauty, accessories, room decor on the same audience.

FOUNDER

Solo founder who has built and sold this kind of company



Aleksei Balchunas

Founder · CEO / CTO

16+ years shipping consumer apps, AI/ML, social and cross-border e-commerce. Hands-on across product, engineering and growth.



Two exits

Hypee → sold to Yandex (~\$3.1M). AI Boost (~\$450K).



Built the AI stack himself

13M-SKU pipeline, embeddings search, recommender. SD image API in 2 days at AI Boost.



Proven operator range

TikTok/Meta performance, funnel analytics, scalable serverless-to-server backends.



This exact playbook

Reached top App Store rank in Brazil at AI Boost, already knows how to launch in LATAM.

THE ASK

Fuel to take the category while the window is open

Raising pre-seed · open on structure: SAFE / convertible / equity

USE OF FUNDS



Build the trust layer (photo studio + refuse-at-warehouse)



Rebuild AI catalog, search & recommendations, clean



Scale TikTok acquisition in US, Brazil, Mexico



QC and cross-border logistics

VISION

Native shopping for the feed generation

Not “search for a product,” but a personal stream of trend pieces with clear prices, real photos, and safe checkout.

In 3-5 years: millions of young women, a proprietary trend + AI layer, deep supplier network and localized logistics.